

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1430

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to commend Stratton Bone on the occasion of an agricultural building in Lebanon being named in his honor.

WHEREAS, neither Wilson County nor the State of Tennessee has ever known a more devoted servant-leader than native son Sam Stratton Bone, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, for his entire life, Mr. Bone has worked assiduously to make Wilson County an even better place through his leadership in numerous civic organizations; and

WHEREAS, a lifetime farmer himself, he has contributed significantly to the agricultural community at both the State and local levels; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of his peerless legacy, a building at the James E. Ward Agricultural Center in Lebanon is being designated the "Stratton Bone Made in Tennessee Building," with a dedication ceremony to be held on April 30, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bone served on the Wilson County Commission for a total of twenty-four years, and he is the sole living commissioner who voted to purchase the land for the James E. Ward Agricultural Center in 1974; and

WHEREAS, Stratton Bone was a valuable member of the Tennessee General Assembly's House of Representatives for seven terms, representing the people of Wilson County with integrity, purpose, and commitment; and

WHEREAS, as Chair of the House Agriculture Committee, he examined the shifting economic climate for his fellow farmers and brought about much-needed innovation and increased funding for agriculture; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bone is renowned as the father of the Tennessee Agricultural Enhancement Program, which, since its inception, has provided over \$289 million to farmers in

all ninety-five Tennessee counties to conduct over 92,500 projects for the purpose of making long-term investments in farms and rural communities; and

WHEREAS, while serving as Chair of the Agriculture Committee, Stratton Bone founded Ag Day on The Hill to draw attention to the importance of agriculture in Tennessee, and this event is still a highlight of each legislative session; and

WHEREAS, Stratton Bone has received numerous awards and accolades for his lifetime of public service, but paramount among these honors is his induction into the Wilson County Agricultural Hall of Fame in 2025; and

WHEREAS, Stratton Bone has set an example that future generations would do well to emulate, and he is most deserving of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commend Stratton Bone on the occasion of the Made in Tennessee Building at the James E. Ward Agricultural Center in Lebanon being named in his honor, recognize his many contributions to Wilson County and this State's agricultural community, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.